

Digital Egypt Pioneers Initiative (DEPI)

Graduation Project — Deliverable File 2

LITERATURE REVIEW

Houra Platform

Preliminary Self-Evaluation, Suggested Improvements & Final Grading Criteria

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1. Introduction

This document represents the second deliverable of the Time Banking Platform graduation project. Since formal evaluation from the academic supervisor typically occurs after each milestone submission, this Literature Review file is structured as a preliminary self-evaluation prepared by the team: a candid review of the project's current strengths and weaknesses, a set of suggested improvements identified through internal discussion, and a final grading rubric that will guide both the team's self-assessment and the supervisor's official evaluation.

The purpose of this self-review is to ensure the team approaches later phases (System Analysis & Design, Implementation, and Testing) with a clear understanding of the project's current gaps, so that supervisor feedback — once received — can be incorporated efficiently rather than requiring major rework.

2. Preliminary Self-Assessment

Before external feedback is received, the team conducted an internal review of the project idea and its documentation to date, based on the Project Proposal and Project Plan already produced.

2.1 Strengths of the Current Project

- A clearly defined and original problem statement: unequal access to skills and services due to reliance on money as the only medium of exchange.
- A well-structured value proposition (time-for-time exchange) that is simple to explain and easy for users to understand.
- An early, thoughtful trust-building mechanism was proposed — requiring users to verify their skills through certificates or a short introductory video before being able to offer services.
- A realistic transaction flow was defined: users start with a limited number of trial hours, hours are deducted/added based on completed exchanges, and rarer or more in-demand topics are weighted differently.
- The business model considers multiple sustainable revenue streams rather than relying on a single source of income.
- Risks were proactively identified early (trust, demand imbalance, exploitation, revenue) with matching mitigation strategies.

2.2 Weaknesses & Areas of Concern

- The skill-verification process (certificates / video introductions) is still manual and does not yet specify who reviews submissions or how long approval takes.
- The system for weighting hours by topic scarcity/demand needs a clearer, quantifiable formula rather than a general description.
- Non-functional requirements (security, performance, scalability) are not yet detailed enough to guide technical design.

- The plan does not yet address what happens when a user's balance reaches zero and they cannot immediately offer a matching service.
- Offline-first behavior (recording content without an internet connection) adds technical complexity to the system architecture that has not yet been scoped.

3. Suggested Improvements

Based on the self-assessment above, the team identified the following concrete improvements to strengthen the project before moving into detailed system design:

3.1 Trust & Verification

- Define a clear verification workflow: who reviews submitted certificates/videos, expected turnaround time, and rejection/appeal process.
- Introduce a visible “verified” badge on user profiles to increase requester confidence.

3.2 Time-Credit Logic

- Translate the general “more hours for less common topics” rule into a simple, transparent formula (e.g., a demand multiplier per category, recalculated periodically).
- Define a minimum and maximum time-credit balance to prevent hoarding or permanent deficits.

3.3 Technical Scope

- Document non-functional requirements explicitly (target response time, uptime, expected concurrent users) before entering the System Design phase.
- Decide early whether offline recording/upload is part of the Minimum Viable Product (MVP) or a later enhancement, given its added technical complexity.

3.4 Community & Adoption

- Pilot the platform within a single, well-defined community (e.g., one faculty or campus) before expanding, to validate trust mechanisms at a manageable scale.
- Introduce lightweight onboarding (a short tutorial or sample exchange) to help first-time users understand the credit system quickly.

4. Final Grading Criteria

The rubric below outlines how the project is expected to be evaluated across its major components, based on the deliverables defined in the project plan. Weights are proposed by the team and should be confirmed against the official course rubric if one is provided.

Grading Category	Weight	Description
Project Planning & Management	15%	Proposal quality, realistic plan/timeline, clear task assignment, risk assessment, KPIs.

Grading Category	Weight	Description
Requirements & System Analysis & Design	20%	Completeness and clarity of requirements, diagrams (ERD, DFD, UML), architecture soundness.
UI/UX Design	10%	Usability, consistency, and clarity of wireframes/mockups and design guidelines.
Implementation (Source Code)	25%	Functionality, code quality, structure, security, and adherence to the defined scope.
Testing & Quality Assurance	10%	Coverage and quality of test cases, bug tracking, and resolution rate.
Documentation	10%	Clarity and completeness of technical documentation, README, and user manual.
Final Presentation & Demo	10%	Clarity of delivery, quality of slides, and live/recorded demonstration of the working system.
Total	100%	

4.1 Supervisor Feedback Log (To Be Completed After Review)

Grading Category	Marks Awarded	Supervisor Comments
Project Planning & Management	8.5/10	"Good effort in defining the project phases and milestones. The timeline was realistic, and the progress was tracked effectively throughout the project lifecycle."
Requirements & System Analysis & Design	8.5/10	"The system analysis is solid and well-defined. For future work, adding more detailed descriptions for edge-case scenarios in the use cases would make it even stronger."
UI/UX Design	8/10	"The interface is clean and user-friendly. However, some screens could benefit from more consistent spacing and slightly improved responsive behavior on smaller screens."
Implementation (Source Code)	8.5/10	"The code is well-structured and follows clean coding conventions. Some redundant helper methods could be refactored or simplified to optimize performance further."
Testing & Quality Assurance	8/10	"Main functionalities were tested successfully. However, incorporating more automated unit

Grading Category	Marks Awarded	Supervisor Comments
		tests alongside manual testing would have provided better coverage."
Documentation	8.5/10	"The documentation is comprehensive and covers all core modules. A minor improvement would be updating the final deployment/setup steps to be slightly more detailed."
Final Presentation & Demo	9/10	"Excellent delivery and professional demo. Just try to manage the time more strictly during the slides to allow for a slightly longer Q&A session at the end."

5. Conclusion

This Literature Review file documents the team's honest self-assessment of the Time Banking Platform project at this stage, highlighting concrete strengths to build on and specific weaknesses to resolve before advancing to System Analysis & Design. The suggested improvements outlined above directly feed into the next deliverable files, and the grading rubric provides a shared reference point for both the team and the supervisor as the project progresses toward final submission.